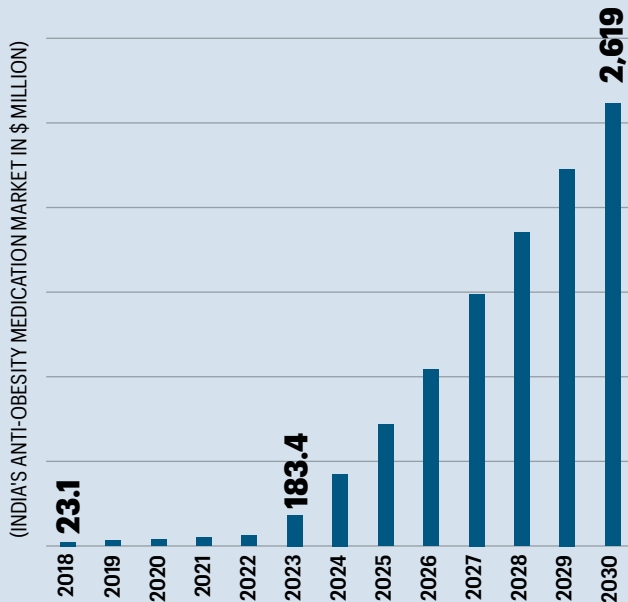


GAINING SHAPE

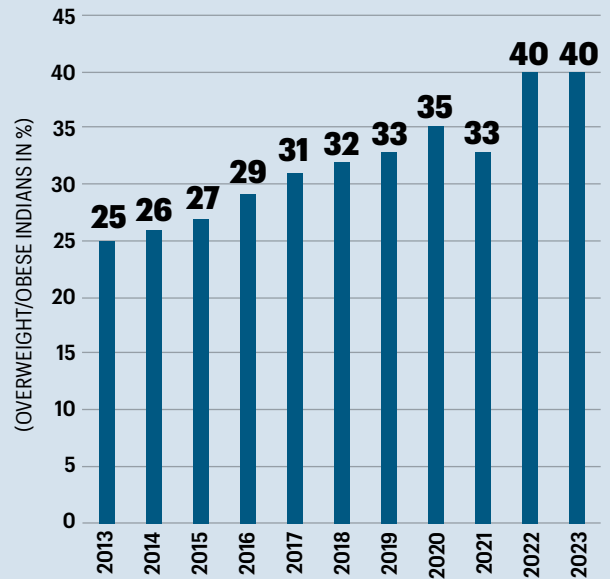
► The anti-obesity medication market in India has seen a big rise from \$23 million in 2018 to \$183 million in 2023. ► It is expected to zoom in the next five years to reach \$2.6 billion



SOURCE HORIZON

OBESITY TRENDS IN INDIA

► There has been a significant increase in the proportion of Indians who are either overweight or obese in the past decade. ► From 25% in 2013 the number of obese Indians has increased to 40% in 2023



SOURCE ICMR-NIN OBESITY AND RELATED DISORDERS REPORT

Then there is diabetes, which is linked to obesity. A study published in *The Lancet* estimates 101 million Indians—about 11.4% of the population—are living with diabetes. The Indian Council of Medical Research's IN-DIAB study reported that 77 million individuals aged 18 and above are affected by Type 2 diabetes, with nearly 25 million being prediabetic. This number is expected to reach 134 million by 2045, according to the International Diabetes Federation (IDF).

Dr Anoop Misra, Chairman of Fortis C-DOC Hospital for Diabetes and Allied Sciences and Director of the National Diabetes Obesity and Cholesterol Foundation (NDOC), says, "Poor dietary choices, lack of physical activity, and urbanisation are contributing to this growing health crisis. Obesity is a major factor in the rise of diabetes, cardiovascular diseases, and fatty liver disorders, which are further straining India's healthcare system."

According to IMARC Group, the weight management market in India was valued at approximately ₹1.73 lakh crore in 2023 and is projected to reach ₹3.99 lakh crore by 2032, growing at a CAGR of 9.3% from 2024 to 2032.

The market includes various segments, such as

weight-loss supplements, fitness products, surgical treatments, and services, with dietary products, particularly weight-loss powders, being the largest revenue-generating segment. Pills are expected to be the fastest-growing category during the forecast period.

Doctors have said that existing solutions, such as lifestyle changes or bariatric surgery, have had limited success in addressing this issue on a large scale. While medications like metformin and liraglutide (Victoza) provide some benefits, they have not been enough to stem the obesity crisis.

A spokesperson from Novo Nordisk highlights the significant health burden in India: "With a population of 254 million individuals living with obesity, there is a need for better treatment and management strategies. Improving awareness and access to care will be important for improving health outcomes."

Novo Nordisk is working to expand access to its treatments in India, with plans to introduce semaglutide injections at a 2.4 mg dose for weight management.

The company also emphasises the importance of addressing India's cultural and dietary habits when pro-